

NICHOLLS STATE UNIVERSITY

Request for HSIRB Exemption

1. Name(s) of Principal Investigator(s): Dr. Christopher Castille Phone: 985-449-7015

Other Investigators: None

Faculty Sponsor (If Student Research): N/A (faculty PI) Phone: _____

2. College: CBA (Al Danos) Department: Management and Marketing Phone: 985-449-7015

3. Title of Project or Proposal: HR Situational Judgment Test: Evidence-Based HR Decision-Making

4. **Description of Project or Proposal (attach additional information as needed):**

- a. Briefly describe the population of human subjects involved (e.g., University students, community members, athletes, homemakers, school children, etc.) **You MUST indicate if this participation is VOLUNTARY or NOT. Subjects must be 18 or older for HSIRB Exemption.**

VOLUNTARY; ages 18+. Adults interested in management topics: (1) Business students (primarily MNGT 425 & MNGT 502) completing this as an in-class assignment (Option A), with qualitative Option B for equivalent credit (grading only; not analyzed as research); (2) working employees (professionals/managers/executives welcome). No flyer. See Attachment A.

- b. Briefly describe your research procedures and techniques of data collection (e.g., interview, questionnaire, test administration, observation of public behavior, etc.). **You MUST include a printed copy of any data collection instrument(s) as well as active link(s) if online or electronic data collection methods are being utilized.**

e-consent → opaque session ID (no PRAMS ID) → optional role category → online SJT (27 scenarios; optional 1–5 ratings; Skip; optional decision notes) → optional feedback report. No deception; no formal debriefing. Emails for updates only on a separate lab form (not formal data). ~45–60 min. IRB instrument: <https://bayoupal.nicholls.edu/hsirb/studies/hr-sjt/run/>. See Attachment A.

- c. Briefly describe the objectives of your research (e.g., what hypotheses you are testing.)

Exploratory: describe tactic-effectiveness ratings; explore (without assuming) differences across role groups (students, professionals, executives, etc.); support MNGT 425/502 teaching; share aggregate findings for community learning/networking. See Attachment A.

5. a. How will you recruit subjects? **YOU MUST submit VERBATIM COPIES** of all letters, emails, notices, advertisements, etc. and/or all oral presentations to be used to recruit subjects/participation in the research project (e.g. scripts of direct person-to-person solicitation, telephone solicitation, newspaper solicitation, letters of solicitation, email solicitation, notices of solicitation posted to Facebook or Moodle, etc.).

No flyer. MNGT 425/502: classroom/LMS assignment Options A (research) / B (qualitative alt; grading only). Community: outreach to working employees interested in management. Separate lab page lists HSIRB-approved studies + optional stay-informed email. See Att. A.

- b. List all criteria for including subjects.

Age 18+; interested in management topics (preferred); MNGT 425/502 students choosing Option A, or working employees / community adults; internet-capable device. See Attachment A.

- c. List all criteria for excluding subjects.

Under 18; unable to complete online assessment; prior participation; Option B choosers (alt not research / not analyzed).

6. Describe subject benefits and costs:

- a. Indicate what, if any, benefits may accrue to each of the following: (Payment to research subjects for participation in studies is considered a benefit.)

1) The human subjects involved:

Course assignment credit (425/502); optional feedback report; contribute to exploratory research; optional aggregate findings via separate email form (not formal data).

2) Individuals who are not subjects, but who may have similar problems:

Students/community may learn from aggregate insights supporting networking around management topics.

3) Society in general:

Exploratory evidence on management/HR tactic ratings; university–community engagement.

- b. State type, amount, method of disbursement, schedule of payment to be offered, and the effect of withdrawal from participation in the study, if any:

No monetary payment. MNGT 425/502: Option A or B earn equivalent assignment credit; Option B not analyzed as research. Community volunteers unpaid.

- c. Estimated costs to each subject due only to the research participation:

1) Time (i.e., total time commitment for the duration of the project)

Approx. 45–60 minutes for SJT; Option B is written alt for instructor only.

2) Money

None.

3) Is repeated testing required? Explain:

Not required.

7. BASIS OF REQUEST FOR EXEMPTION - One of the following (A-E) must be checked.

- _____ A. The research will be conducted only in established or commonly accepted educational settings (like classrooms) **AND** it involves normal educational practices such as research on regular and special educational instructional strategies, or research on the effectiveness of, or the comparison among, instructional techniques, curricula or classroom management methods.
- _____ B. It will be conducted using only questionnaire or interview survey methods **AND** the subjects are elected or appointed public officials or candidates for public office.
- _____ C. It is limited to the collection and study of existing data, documents, records, pathological or diagnostic specimens which are available to the public.

(Request options for exemption continued on next page)

- ☒ D. It is limited to the collection and study of data obtained using only the following techniques **AND** the data or information obtained will be recorded in such a manner that subjects cannot be *identified, directly or indirectly*, through identifiers linked with the subjects:

Check the applicable technique(s):

- ☒ 1. The data will be obtained through the use of educational tests (cognitive, diagnostic, aptitude, achievement, etc.), or
- ☐ 2. Data will be obtained by observing the public behavior of subjects, or
- ☒ 3. Data will be obtained using survey or interview procedures, or
- ☐ 4. Data will be obtained from existing documents, records, pathological or diagnostic specimens.

- ☐ E. It is limited to the collection and study of data obtained by:

1. Observing the public behavior of the participants, or
2. Using survey or interview procedures, **AND:**

BOTH OF THE FOLLOWING MUST BE CHECKED IF E-2 IS THE BASIS FOR THE REQUESTED EXEMPTION:

- ☐ i) The information collected about the subjects behavior ***does not involve*** sensitive subjects such as illegal or immoral conduct, drug or alcohol use, sexual behavior, mental illness, or other possibly personally embarrassing subjects **AND**,
- ☐ ii) The information collected about subjects, if it became known to outsiders, could not reasonably be expected to place the subject at risk of civil or criminal liability, or be damaging to the subjects social or financial standing or employability.

8. **Attach copies of current CITI Training certificate(s) for all investigators. Faculty Sponsors of student research must provide a copy of their current CITI Training certificate. Please be sure to select (enroll) and complete the appropriate series of modules based on your area / learner group. URL TO CITI TRAINING: <https://about.citiprogram.org/en/homepage/> There are 5 different learner groups for Nicholls State University:**

Faculty Researchers / Faculty Sponsors – If you are conducting research involving human subjects or if you are the faculty sponsor / supervisor of student research which does NOT involve the areas of biomedical research. **NOTE: Nursing and Allied Health Faculty are required to complete the HIPAA module (not suggested as for all other faculty).**

Student Researchers (Not Nursing/Allied Health): Any research being conducted by a student or student group (either thesis, class project, service/experiential learning, or academic oriented research) where human subjects are involved (surveyed, experimental design, and/or observation).

IRB Members: Any member of the HSIRB Committee at Nicholls State University

CITI attached: Christopher Castille — Human Subjects Research / Faculty Researchers and Research Sponsors (Basic). Completion 10-May-2024; Expiration 10-May-2026; Record ID 59381539. Certificate appended to this PDF.

Nursing and Allied Health Students: Modules in this group include the Basic Social-Behavioral-Educational Modules as well as additional required modules, as required by consensus of the Faculty within the respective College and Department.

Biomedical Data or Specimens/Researchers (Faculty and Students): Any Faculty / Students whose Research involves the use or collection of biomedical data and/or specimens.

NOTE: Depending on the exact protocols used. If additional data is collected by means of a survey from subjects, then the researchers (both faculty, faculty sponsors and students) are required to complete additional modules (Faculty – Faculty Researchers/Research Sponsors; Students – Student Researchers (Not Nursing or Allied Health)).

9. STATEMENT OF RISK:

The undersigned certify that they believe that the conduct of the above described research creates no risk of physical or emotional harm, or social or legal embarrassment to any participating human subject.

Dr. Christopher Castille _____ (Sign/date upon submission)
Signature of Principal Investigator Date

10. FACULTY SPONSOR (if a student is the principal investigator)

N/A — Principal Investigator is faculty _____
Signature of Faculty Sponsor Date

11. RECOMMENDATION OF HSIRB REPRESENTATIVE OR HSIRB CHAIR:

I recommend that the above described research project be exempt from review.

Signature of Chairperson Date HSIRB PROTOCOL NUMBER _____
(Assigned by HSIRB)

NOTE – APPROVE HSIRB Research is valid for a 12 month period of time from the date approved. Approved research can be renewed and extended for a 1 year period at the request of the principle investigator / faculty member – PRIOR to the expiration of an existing HSIRB Protocol Number. Projects can be renewed a maximum of two (2) times. Any faculty wishing to continue a research project beyond year 3 must submit a new request. If approved, a new HSIRB Protocol Number will be issued.

The mailing or distribution of surveys or the collection of data may begin ONLY after this form has received committee approval (ALLOW 10 DAYS FOR PROCESSING) and has been properly filed with the HSIRB Representative or HSIRB Chairperson. It must have signatures of the Principal Investigator(s) or Faculty Sponsor. The Committee may, upon review of this application, deny the request for an exemption. To inquire about approval status, please contact the HSIRB Representative you submitted the application to or the HSIRB Chairperson.

ATTACHMENT A — HSIIRB Exempt Review Request (rev9 2019)

Project: HR Situational Judgment Test: Evidence-Based HR Decision-Making

PI: Dr. Christopher Castille | Phone: 985-449-7015 | Email: christopher.castille@nicholls.edu

College: Al Danos College of Business Administration | Dept: Management and Marketing

4a. Population of human subjects

VOLUNTARY; ages 18+. Adults interested in management topics: (1) Business students (primarily MNGT 425 & MNGT 502) completing this as an in-class assignment (Option A), with qualitative Option B for equivalent credit (grading only; not analyzed as research); (2) working employees (professionals/managers/executives welcome). No flyer. See Attachment A.

4b. Research procedures and data collection

e-consent → opaque session ID (no PRAMS ID) → optional role category → online SJT (27 scenarios; optional 1–5 ratings; Skip; optional decision notes) → optional feedback report. No deception; no formal debriefing. Emails for updates only on a separate lab form (not formal data). ~45–60 min. IRB instrument: <https://bayoupal.nicholls.edu/hsirb/studies/hr-sjt/run/>. See Attachment A.

4c. Objectives of the research

Exploratory: describe tactic-effectiveness ratings; explore (without assuming) differences across role groups (students, professionals, executives, etc.); support MNGT 425/502 teaching; share aggregate findings for community learning/networking. See Attachment A.

5a. Recruitment (verbatim script)

MNGT 425 / MNGT 502 — Classroom Assignment Announcement (verbatim; no flyer) Study Title: HR Situational Judgment Test: Evidence-Based HR Decision-Making As an in-class assignment, you are asked to participate in an exploratory research study on how people interested in management topics rate the effectiveness of workplace tactics. Option A — Research study assignment: Complete the online HR Situational Judgment Test (27 scenarios). You may rate tactic effectiveness (optional; you may skip any situation) and optionally add notes about how you are thinking through each decision. After informed consent, your ratings may be included in the research dataset. Duration: approximately 45–60 minutes. Must be 18 or older. Option B — Alternative assignment (not research / not analyzed as study data): Write a qualitative description of how you would respond to each scenario prompt and submit it to the instructor for equivalent course credit. This is used only for grading. Both options satisfy the course assignment. --- Community / working employees — outreach description (verbatim): Study Title: HR Situational Judgment Test: Evidence-Based HR Decision-Making You are invited to complete an online situational judgment exercise with 27 workplace scenarios. We welcome working employees and others interested in management topics. Participation is voluntary, takes about 45–60 minutes, and is for adults 18+. Aggregate findings may later be shared with participants who optionally join a separate lab mailing list.

5b. Inclusion criteria

- Must be at least 18 years of age - Interested in management topics (preferred) - For course-credit path: currently enrolled in MNGT 425 or MNGT 502 at Nicholls and choose Option A (research assignment) - For community path: working employee or other adult interested in management topics - Access to a computer/device with internet; able to complete a web-based assessment

5c. Exclusion criteria

- Under 18 years of age - Unable to complete the online assessment due to technical limitations - Previously participated in this study (duplicate responses) - Chose the qualitative alternative assignment (Option B) — those submissions are not research data and are not analyzed as part of this study

6a–c. Benefits, payment, and costs

Course assignment credit (425/502); optional feedback report; contribute to exploratory research; optional aggregate findings via separate email form (not formal data). | Others: Students/community may learn from aggregate insights supporting networking around management topics. | Society: Exploratory evidence on management/HR tactic ratings; university–community engagement. | Payment: No monetary payment. MNGT 425/502: Option A or B earn equivalent assignment credit; Option B not analyzed as research. Community volunteers unpaid. | Time: Approx. 45–60 minutes for SJT; Option B is written alt for instructor only. | Money: None. | Repeated testing: Not required.

7. Basis of exemption — Category D (techniques 1 and 3)

This study qualifies for exempt status under Category D because: 1. Minimal risk (online situational judgment ratings and optional notes) 2. Research data are recorded with opaque session identifiers only — no PRAMS ID numbers; names and emails are not stored with research ratings 3. Standard educational / survey procedures; no deception; no formal debriefing required 4. Adults 18+; no targeted vulnerable populations 5. Optional emails for aggregate updates are collected on a separate form and are not part of formal SJT data collection Techniques: (1) educational tests / cognitive SJT; (3) survey procedures.

8. CITI training

Christopher Castille — Human Subjects Research / Faculty Researchers and Research Sponsors (Basic Course). Completion 10-May-2024; Expiration 10-May-2026; Record ID 59381539. Certificate attached.

9. Statement of risk (supporting narrative)

Minimal risk. Possible mild boredom or fatigue; optional feedback may differ from expectations. Privacy risk is minimal because research ratings use opaque session identifiers (no PRAMS IDs; no names/emails with ratings). Risks are no greater than ordinary coursework or online surveys. Mitigation: 1. Equivalent alternative assignment for MNGT 425 / MNGT 502 (Option B; grading only; not analyzed as research). 2. Opaque session identifiers only for research ratings — no PRAMS IDs; names/emails not stored with ratings. 3. Optional ratings, Skip, optional notes; withdraw anytime without penalty. 4. No deception; no formal debriefing. 5. Optional emails collected only on a separate lab form, not linked as formal study data. 6. Secure university-hosted storage; access limited to PI / authorized personnel.

Active links for IRB review

Interactive instrument (skip/optional ratings): <https://bayoupal.nicholls.edu/hsirb/studies/hr-sjt/run/> | Professional consent: <https://bayoupal.nicholls.edu/hsirb/studies/hr-sjt/professional-consent/> | Class/student consent: <https://bayoupal.nicholls.edu/hsirb/studies/hr-sjt/student-data-consent/> | Full branded packet: [materials/pdf/HSIRB_Application_HR_SJT_Rating_Effectiveness_full_packet.pdf](#)



Completion Date 10-May-2024
Expiration Date 10-May-2026
Record ID 59381539

This is to certify that:

Christopher Castille

Has completed the following CITI Program course:

Not valid for renewal of
certification through CME.

Human Subjects Research
(Curriculum Group)
Faculty Researchers and Research Sponsors
(Course Learner Group)
1 - Basic Course
(Stage)

Under requirements set by:

Nicholls State University

CITI
Collaborative Institutional Training Initiative

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